

Debt Free App — Competitor Pricing Analysis

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1. Market Landscape — Competitor Pricing

App	Model	Pricing	Downloads	Rating
YNAB	Subscription	\$14.99/mo or \$109/yr (\$9.08/mo)	1M+	4.6★
Debt Payoff Planner (OxbowSoft)	Freemium + Sub	~\$4.99–6.99/mo (ads + IAP)	500K+	4.4★
Debt Payoff Box (Apps of the Future UK)	Freemium (2 debts free)	In-app purchases	10K+	3.6★
Debt Payoff Planner: Snowball (LKPixel)	Freemium + ads	One-time premium purchase	500+	New
DebtTrack (Devonshire Logic)	Paid upfront	£3.59 one-time	Small	—
PocketGuard	Freemium + Sub	~\$7.99/mo or \$34.99/yr	Large	4.2★

Key observation: A reviewer on Debt Payoff Planner (OxbowSoft) noted "the monthly cost is a little high" for the subscription. Debt Payoff Box received negative reviews for limiting free users to only 2 debts.

2. Feature Comparison — Competitive Advantages

Feature	Debt Free App	Debt Payoff Planner	YNAB
Per-debt extra payments	✓	✗	✗
UK PAYE / NI / Student Loan tax engine	✓	✗	✗

Feature	Debt Free App	Debt Payoff Planner	YNAB
Mortgage overpayment simulator	✓	Basic	✗
Salary sacrifice calculator	✓	✗	✗
AI insights (Gemini 2.5 Flash)	✓	✗	✗
Scenario what-if builder	✓	Basic slider	✗
Monthly budget tracking	✓	✗	✓ (core)
Planner with what-if events	✓	✗	✗
Avalanche + Snowball strategies	✓	✓	Partial
No ads, privacy-focused	✓	✗ (ads)	✓
Bank sync / Open Banking	✗	✗	✓
Multi-device sync	✗	✓	✓

3. Recommended Pricing

Recommended Monthly Price

£3.99/month

or £29.99/year (£2.50/mo — 37% saving)

Below YNAB (\$14.99/mo) · Above simple calculators (£0–5 one-time)

Rationale

- **Below YNAB** — YNAB is a full-budget platform with bank sync, live support, and 1M+ users. You're not competing at their scale or cost base yet.

- **Above pure debt calculators** — Your app provides significantly more value than simple debt snowball calculators through AI insights, UK tax engine, mortgage simulator, and scenario planning.
- **UK market positioning** — The UK personal finance app market is underserved vs. the US. £3.99/mo is the "impulse subscribe" threshold for UK consumers.
- **AI operating costs covered** — Firebase AI (Gemini) has per-request costs that a subscription model sustains.
- **Competitive with niche competitors** — Undercuts OxbowSoft's subscription (their users complain it's "a little high") while offering more features.

4. Suggested Free vs Premium Split

Free Tier	Premium (£3.99/mo)
Up to 2 debts	Unlimited debts
Basic payoff timeline chart	Per-debt extra payment allocation
Budget overview (view only)	Full budget management + monthly tracking
Avalanche / Snowball selection	Mortgage overpayment simulator
—	Scenario what-if builder
—	AI Insights (Gemini-powered)
—	Salary sacrifice calculator
—	Planner with what-if events
—	Data export / import

5. Alternative Price Points

Strategy	Monthly	Annual	When to use
Aggressive growth	£2.49/mo	£19.99/yr	Maximise installs, build user base fast
Recommended	£3.99/mo	£29.99/yr	Balance value perception + accessibility
Premium positioning	£4.99/mo	£39.99/yr	Emphasise AI + UK tax intelligence
Future (with Open Banking)	£6.99/mo	£54.99/yr	Only after adding bank sync / connected accounts

6. Key Takeaways

Summary

- **£3.99/month** (or £29.99/year) is the sweet spot for a UK-focused niche app with AI features and no established brand recognition.
- **AI Insights** should be the flagship premium feature — it's unique in the market and has real operating costs.
- **Free tier limited to 2 debts** provides enough value to demonstrate the app while creating clear upgrade motivation.
- **Annual discount (37%)** encourages commitment and reduces churn.
- Future price increases to £4.99–6.99 are justified once you add Open Banking integration or multi-device sync.